Prompting Techniques

Zero-Shot • One-Shot • Few-Shot • System • Role • Contextual

Question 1: Zero-Shot Prompting

📝 **Prompt:**

Read the following story and summarize it in 5–6 sentences.

"The Tortoise and the Hare" is one of Aesop's Fables — a story where a boastful, fast hare challenges a slow tortoise to a race, gets overconfident, takes a nap, and is ultimately beaten by the tortoise's steady, persistent pace, teaching the moral that "slow and steady wins the race".

✅ **Response:**

"The Tortoise and the Hare" is a classic fable by Aesop that teaches an enduring life lesson through a simple animal race. The hare, confident in his natural speed, mocks the slow tortoise and challenges him to a race. During the race, the hare grows so sure of winning that he stops for a nap, underestimating his opponent. The tortoise, never wavering, keeps moving at his own steady pace throughout the entire course. When the hare finally wakes and rushes to the finish line, he finds the tortoise has already won.
The fable delivers a timeless moral: consistent effort and perseverance will triumph over raw talent wasted through arrogance and laziness.

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Question 2: One-Shot Prompting

📝 **Prompt:**

Convert the name format from "First Name Last Name" to "Last Name, First Name."

Example: John Doe ´n Doe, John

Now convert this name: Sarah Ahmed

✅ **Response:**

Ahmed, Sarah

Question 3: Few-Shot Prompting

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📝 **Prompt:**

Below are three examples of short product descriptions written in a friendly and catchy style:

1. "This stainless steel water bottle keeps your drinks cold for 24 hours and hot for 12. Perfect for school, office, or travel!"
2. "Our soft cotton t-shirts are breathable, stylish, and comfortable — designed for everyday confidence."
3. "This compact power bank charges your phone quickly and fits easily in your pocket."

Now write a new product description for a smartwatch using the same style.

✅ **Response:**

"Meet your new everyday companion! This sleek smartwatch tracks your steps, monitors your heart rate, and keeps you on top of notifications — all from your wrist. With a long-lasting battery and a stylish design that goes from the gym to the office, it's the upgrade your daily routine has been waiting for!"

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Question 4: System Prompting

📝 **Prompt (System Instructions):**

You are a professional customer service AI assistant. Follow these rules at all times:

- Always be polite, respectful, and helpful.
- Use simple and clear language.
- Never provide false information.
- Do not use rude, offensive, or harmful language.
- If you don't know something, say "I'm sorry, I don't have that information."
- Maintain a calm and professional tone in every response.

✅ **Response (Sample Interaction):**

User: "My order hasn't arrived yet. It's been two weeks!"

Assistant: "Hello! Thank you for reaching out, and I'm sorry to hear your order hasn't arrived yet — I completely understand how frustrating that can be. Could you please share your order number so I can look into this for you right away? I want to make sure we get this sorted out as quickly as possible. Thank you for your patience!"

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Question 5: Role Prompting

📝 **Prompt:**

Act as a professional history teacher with 15 years of experience.
Explain in detail the main causes and long-term effects of World War I.
Provide your explanation as if teaching Grade 10 students.

✅ **Response:**

"Good morning, class! Today we're diving into one of the most important events in modern history — World War I. Let's start with the causes, which I like to remember using the acronym MAIN.

M — Militarism: European powers were in an arms race, building larger armies and navies. This created an atmosphere of tension and competition.

A — Alliance Systems: Europe was divided into two armed camps — the Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and the Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain). When one country went to war, all its allies were dragged in.

I — Imperialism: European nations competed fiercely for colonies in Africa and Asia, creating rivalry and resentment.

N — Nationalism: People across Europe — especially in the Balkans — had strong desires for independence. The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand in 1914 was the spark that ignited all these underlying tensions.

Long-Term Effects: The war reshaped the entire world. Four empires collapsed — the Ottoman, Austro-Hungarian, Russian, and German empires. The harsh Treaty of Versailles humiliated Germany, planting seeds of resentment that would later fuel the rise of Adolf Hitler and World War II. New nations were born in Eastern Europe. The League of Nations was established — the first attempt at international peacekeeping. And millions of soldiers returned home changed forever, leaving a generation scarred by trauma.

So remember: WWI wasn't caused by one event — it was the result of decades of tension finally exploding. And its effects are still felt in the world today."

Question 6: Contextual Prompting

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📝 **Prompt (Context Provided):**

I run a small home-based bakery.
- I sell cakes and cupcakes.
- My monthly budget for marketing is very limited ($50).
- I mainly use Facebook and WhatsApp.
- My target customers are mothers and working women.
- Sales have decreased in the last 3 months.

Based only on this information, create a simple 1-month marketing plan to increase sales.

✅ **Response — 1-Month Marketing Plan:**

📅 WEEK 1 — Build Visibility (Budget: ~$10)
- Post 3 high-quality photos of your cakes/cupcakes on Facebook with warm captions targeting moms (e.g., "The perfect birthday cake for your little one 🎂").
- Create a WhatsApp Status update daily showing fresh baked items.
- Ask 5 existing customers to share a photo of your product on their stories.

📅 WEEK 2 — Engagement & Offers (Budget: ~$15)
- Run a Facebook post: "Tag a working mom who deserves a treat — winner gets a free cupcake box!" (Boosts organic reach at zero cost.)
- Offer a "Buy 6 cupcakes, get 1 free" deal for WhatsApp orders only.

📅 WEEK 3 — Paid Boost (Budget: ~$20)
- Boost your best-performing Facebook post with $20, targeting women aged 25–45 in your local area.
- Share a short behind-the-scenes WhatsApp video of your baking process.

📅 WEEK 4 — Loyalty & Retention (Budget: ~$5)
- Send a personal WhatsApp message to past customers with a small discount code for their next order.
- Post a "Thank You" message with a customer photo (with permission) to build trust.

💡 Key Tips:
- Always post in the morning (7–9am) when moms and working women check their phones.
- Use warm, real photos — not stock images.
- Respond to every comment and message within 1 hour to build relationships.

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